INVESTMENT PROPOSITION

Fund the relationship. Make development visible.

A costed Alchemy proposal and a framework for commissioning Silkfutures

Silkfutures offers relationship-led creative mentoring in Cardiff: purposeful creative work, a consistent person to turn to, and supported opportunities to build confidence, agency and connection.

The problem to address

Some young people need more than access to equipment or a one-off activity. The records describe uncertainty, self-criticism, difficulty sustaining engagement and a need for patient encouragement. These are observations within the service, not a population needs assessment.

Public Health Wales' secondary-school dashboard, updated 22 October 2026, provides current contextual evidence on wellbeing and inequalities, including local-authority breakdowns. It reports associations with family affluence. That context does not establish the needs of every Silkfutures participant or cover the full 11–25 age range. [F1]

The proposed response

Use creative practice as a setting for relationship and development. Agree a young person's own goal; offer manageable opportunities to create and contribute; notice change in what they can do and how much support they need; review the next step together. Keep referral and safeguarding responsibilities explicit.

This document uses verified organisational records and an existing application budget. It does not invent a £10,000–£50,000 package. Alchemy remains a proposal; other offers require an approved cost model before a price is quoted.

01 / WHY THIS MODEL

Distinctive in combination, not unique by assertion

Practice	Why it matters	Accountability
Trust and continuity	A young person can return without having to perform confidence immediately.	Named mentor, review plan, supervision and safe boundaries.
Real creative work	Writing, production and performance make effort and decisions visible.	Track actual work, support required and participant choices.
Responsive mentoring	An interest beyond music can reopen engagement.	Record why the plan changed and what happened next.
A route to contribution	Young people can help peers and potentially move into facilitation.	Verify paid roles and sustained destinations separately.
Pathways evidence	A shared language for developmental observations.	Publish rules and limitations; avoid automatic success claims.

These elements also exist in good youth work elsewhere. Silkfutures should claim a specific combination and demonstrate its delivery, rather than claiming that conventional youth services lack relationships or creativity.

Evidence of promise

281 engagement records across 89 dates; 22 of 28 paired identities with higher confidence scores; detailed journeys toward more independent creative work. Relationship scores are mixed, and longer-term outcomes are unverified. This supports investment in delivery with proportionate evaluation, rather than a claim of proven prevention or savings.

Evidence period 14 January–13 October 2026. See the Impact Report for denominators, identity issues, missingness and context-dependent scales. [F2]

02 / THE COSTED OPPORTUNITY

Alchemy: existing budget, explicit conditions

The reviewed Arts Council of Wales application describes five emerging artists aged 16–21 and a 24-week delivery model within a 2027 project period. The final budget supports seven one-hour individual sessions per artist and three two-hour group sessions. This is 35 individual delivery hours plus six group hours: 41 facilitator-session hours, not 24 weekly two-hour sessions.

Budget heading	Verified amount
Facilitator and support fees	£4,760
Activity costs, including studio and access support	£2,400
Promotion and documentation	£1,700
Evaluation	£300
Administration	£1,440
In-kind venue support	£245
Contingency	£400
TOTAL PROJECT VALUE	£11,245

Funding source in budget	Amount	Status
Arts Council of Wales request	£10,000	Application, not confirmed award
Personal fundraising / JustGiving	£1,000	Marked confirmed in budget; receipt not verified
Venue in-kind contribution	£245	Marked confirmed in budget; non-cash

Cash expenditure: £11,000. Source: “Silkfutures -Create Project Budget - final.xlsx”. The application receipt is dated 6 October 2026. Do not seek duplicate funding for the same costs. [F3–F4]

03 / VALUE FOR MONEY

Explain what the budget buys

Cost driver	Basis in the final budget
Individual mentoring	7 sessions × 5 artists × £100 = £3,500, including planning/reporting. This is a budget unit, not an hourly wage.
Group support	Facilitator: 3 × £300 = £900; safeguarding: 3 × £60 = £180; assistant: 3 × £60 = £180.
Creative space	41 hours × £40 = £1,640. Confirm related-party terms and demonstrate fair value.
Access and materials	Transport £550; refreshments £110; USBs £100.
Documentation and evaluation	Promotion £400; film £1,300; evaluation £300. Agree how documentation benefits participants and funders.
Administration	3 hours per week × £20 per hour × 24 weeks = £1,440. Confirm these administration tasks are distinct from the planning/reporting included in session fees.

Planned cost per artist: £2,249 total project value, £2,200 cash expenditure and £2,000 grant request. These are budget ratios for five planned places, not observed cost-effectiveness. At full group attendance, the plan offers up to 65 participant-contact hours: 35 individual plus 30 group participant-hours.

Before commitment, reconcile the application’s 24-session language, the 24-week model and the separate 12-week proposition discussed internally. Agree exactly what each participant receives, dates, staffing and payment milestones. Check for overlap between planning/reporting, administration and evaluation costs.

Do not divide the organisation’s annual expenditure by this CSV’s records to produce a cost per outcome: the periods, populations and units do not match. [F3]

04 / OUTCOMES AND REPORTING

Promise delivery; test development

Level	Proposed commitment / measure	Evidence
Outputs	Offer five artist places and the sessions specified in the reconciled plan.	Participant/event IDs, attendance and delivered hours; reasons for non-completion.
Creative agency	Review each participant’s chosen creative goal and support required.	Work examples and participant reflection at entry, midpoint and exit.
Confidence and engagement	Use consistent context-specific questions and behavioural anchors.	Report complete pairs and missing responses, including unchanged or lower results.
Relationships and belonging	Ask whether the young person feels listened to and supported.	Private voluntary feedback, including concerns and negative experiences.
Progression	Record opportunities offered, started and sustained.	Consent-based confirmation at exit and proposed three-month follow-up.
Learning and safety	Review adaptation, supervision and safeguarding systems.	Aggregate learning; no sensitive case details in funder reports.

These are recommended reporting commitments, not outcomes already achieved or guarantees that every young person will improve. Agree targets after the cohort, starting needs and delivery specification are fixed. Do not reward mentors solely for higher scores or higher stages.

A proportionate funder relationship

Agree an inception plan, a midpoint learning conversation and a final account of delivery, development and expenditure. A commissioner should also agree referral eligibility, responsibilities, attendance expectations, information-sharing arrangements and an appropriate route when specialist support is needed.

05 / INVESTMENT READINESS

What an institutional partner should receive

Silkfutures CIC is a company limited by guarantee, company number 12461003. Signed unaudited accounts for the year ended 28 February 2026 report turnover of £85,652 and a net deficit of £568. Grants of £81,268 represent approximately 94.9% of turnover. This indicates substantial grant dependence, not by itself organisational failure. [F5]

Before an award or contract, provide current management accounts and cash-flow forecast; restricted/unrestricted fund reconciliation; approved budget; board and conflict declarations; safeguarding, complaints and insurance evidence; staff supervision arrangements; and written terms for use of SilkCrayon facilities and any delivery through associated organisations.

Routes to investment

The current Alchemy arts application should be managed as a distinct artist-development proposal. A community grant should instead lead with young people’s priorities, access and relational development. A commission should purchase a defined service with full costs and responsibilities. Core-capacity investment should describe an organisational change that remains after the grant ends.

> The invitation: invest in a specific, accountable offer that protects the continuity of mentoring and improves the quality of evidence. The next step is to agree the cohort, delivery schedule, cost allocation and reporting commitments.

Sources: [F1] Public Health Wales, Secondary School Children’s Health and Well-being Dashboard, 22 October 2026: https://phw.nhs.wales/reports/secondary-school-childrens-health-and-well-being-dashboard/ [F2] Full Pathways CSV and current application code; see Impact Report. [F3] Final Alchemy Create Project Budget workbook, Google Drive, inspected 24 October 2026. [F4] ACW application 2026011152 receipt, 6 October 2026; application pages available in the attachment extraction reviewed. [F5] Signed Silkfutures accounts, year ended 28 February 2026, supplied via connected Drive. Figures are historical, not a current solvency assessment. Contact: nathan@silkfutures.com • www.silkfutures.com